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Wellington & District LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Euchareena, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbon and Yeoval districts.

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\$2.50
Inc GST

WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

Racing at Wellington Thursday August 13

Full TAB -7-race card

It's a great day out!!

Lions Book Fair grand reopening - P 5

Scabbing Flat Bridge incidents - P 7

2026 Eisteddfod program- Page 15-16

Rivercare launched

WE'VE BEEN blessed with some beautiful warm sunny days recently and last Saturday was no exception.

It was just the day for Mid Macquarie Landcare to launch a new initiative, Wellington Rivercare.

The group's call out for volunteers was rewarded by 10 people who turned up during mid-morning ready to volunteer their services for the benefit of the Bell River environment.

Landcare coordinator, Deb Cooke said the group was asking volunteers to participate once a month.

"Rivercare is an initiative of Md Macquarie Landcare and we are calling for volunteers to join us once a month to work on the riparian zone of the Bell River," she said.

The work involves litter collection and bush regeneration. She said the group just wanted to look after this incredibly stretch of the Bell River running through town and separates our two lovely parks, Cameron Park on the east bank and Pioneer on the western side.

"Volunteers don't need bush regeneration skills as we will teach you. This area is such an asset to Wellington.

"And as people may know this is platypus habitat which is also incredibly special."

M Cooke said she thought there were a lot of people who felt that they would like to help restore this area.

Asked what other projects were coming up she said they had a lot going on this year.

"We will be conducting an edible weeds workshop in the park identifying which weeds are in fact edible on Tuesday, September 8," she said. This will give a very different perspective on weeds."

Another weeds related workshop will be held in November finding special weeds from which to make personal products. to exhibit," she said.

"I'm sure the more the community becomes aware of what we are about, our membership will build.

"It doesn't take a lot of volunteers to make a difference."

Emmalee Holmes, Judith Manning, Vicki Wright, Danielle Littlewood, Cecilie Beatson, Terry Kavanagh and Deborah Cook.

More photos Page 4

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Wellington Lions Club Bookshop re-opening

HOW GOOD was it to attend the Wellington Lions Club Bookshop Re-opening last Saturday morning.

The amazing volunteers have put in a huge amount of effort to create a unique and important space for the public to enjoy, but also to raise funds for community projects.

I went home with an armful of fantastic books for myself and the extended family, including an old school atlas from 1977 with the maps of each state with the different primary production zones marked – something that isn't really taught to school kids today!

What's happening with the Wiradjuri Tourism Centre?

Last week Councillors voted on the future of the Wiradjuri Tourism Centre with the decision being to declining all tenders, with each submission exceeding the available budget allocation.

The project has \$12 million of State and Federal grant funding and is to be built in Dubbo, but tell the story of the Wiradjuri people of the whole region.

The Centre will still be built, but with a change of direction to rescope and deliver the project within the funding envelope.

Council acknowledges this represents a change in direction for the project again and recognises the significant work that has been undertaken over many years.

However, due to ongoing delays, project deferrals and escalating construction costs, the project in its current form is no longer considered financially sustainable or affordable for the community.

The decision means Council has an opportunity to reassess the project and determine what can be realistically delivered within the financial constraints, while also providing value and benefit for the community.

Dubbo/Wellington Region as NSW's top property market as regional demand surges

InfoTrack has released figures showing the Dubbo Region, including the Wellington area, has come out as the top location for overall property sales across New South Wales in the second quarter of 2026, overtaking Port Macquarie.

The region recorded a 24 per cent increase in overall property purchases over the months of April-May-June.

In NSW houses continue to lead buyer activity, accounting for 67pc of all transactions.

The growing demand for property in our region shows the great affordability, infrastructure investment and strong, diverse local economies, along with good healthcare, education, agriculture, mining and renewable energy that is helping to maintain the sustained demand.

Orange was in third place, Port Macquarie fourth, and Armidale was also in

the top-10.

This region was also ranked sixth highest for purchases by first home buyers. Orange improved from fifth to third in the first home buyer stakes, and it was interesting to read that the median purchase price climbed 9pc from the previous quarter to \$728,000.

The Central West of NSW really is a great place to live!

Grant funds

Opportunities open now include:

- * Community Funding Program
- * Community Clean-Up Fund
- * Destination Events Fund

We've also listed on the DRC website grants and funding streams not managed by Council that residents of our region might be eligible to apply for.

View grants and funding opportunities at the DDRC page, or contact Council to seek further information.

Josh Black

Government must stand up to global AI giants



Reproduced from B&T Media July 15, 2026.

Australia's copyright laws must not be rewritten at the urging of some of the world's richest and most powerful technology companies, argues Star News Group managing director Paul Thomas, (above) a life member of Country Press Australia.

WHEN GLOBAL AI giants lobby governments while simultaneously offering billions of dollars in investment, there is an obvious risk that the rights of Australian creators, publishers and journalists will be treated as an inconvenience to be negotiated away.

A report by Noah Yim in The Australian revealed that AI company Anthropic had sought "clarity" from Treasurer Jim Chalmers and other senior government figures on Australian copyright laws.

According to the report, Anthropic argued that negotiating with the "long tail" of smaller rights holders could complicate its proposed investment in Australian AI infrastructure.

That argument should concern every Australian creator and publisher.

The difficulty of negotiating with thousands of smaller rights holders is not a reason to use their work without permission or payment.

It is a reason for the government to urgently establish a collective licensing system that ensures creators are fairly compensated.

This is particularly critical for regional and local news media. Local journalism is essential democratic infrastructure.

It places reporters in council chambers, courts and community meetings. It exposes wrongdoing, tests claims made by politicians and institutions, and gives communities reliable information about the decisions affecting their lives.

That role is more important now than at any time in living memory.

Social media is awash with misinformation, deliberate lies, manipulated images, anonymous accusations and AI-generated content presented as fact.

Trusted local journalists provide something increasingly rare: information that has been gathered, checked and published by people and organisations that can be held accountable.

But quality journalism is expensive to produce and increasingly difficult to fund.

When AI companies use professionally produced reporting, photographs and other original content to build commercial products, that material is not simply free "data".

It is valuable intellectual property created through substantial investment.

Australia should welcome AI development and new technology infrastructure. But investment cannot become leverage to weaken copyright protections or avoid paying the people whose work helped create that value.

The government must act quickly to establish clear licensing rules, transparency over what content has been used, and fair compensation for both past and continuing use.

Without sustainable regional and local news media, communities lose scrutiny, accountability and one of their strongest defences against misinformation.

The principle should be simple: powerful global technology companies should not be permitted to profit from Australian creative work without fairly compensating the people and businesses that created it.

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Wellington & District LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O'Brien

Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Euchareena to Elong Elong and Yeoval within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

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Buy local - grow local

CHOOSING TO spend in a Wellington business means more of that money stays in the town.

Dubbo Regional Council is using its latest campaign to remind residents that choosing local businesses over bigger centres helps keep more jobs, services and money in the community.

Looking at the power behind your spend, the campaign highlights the amount of money that stays within a community depending on where you choose to spend it.

For every \$100 spent online, only around \$4.30 stays in the local community, compared with approximately \$71.25 when you spend \$100 with a local business.

Beyond the dollars, supporting local also means backing the people, families and stories behind each business, strengthening the fabric of the community.

KOR Health owner Claudia Schick said shopping local was more than commerce. It's about strengthening our community.

"It not only makes it a place people want to visit but one where you would want to stay and start a business or raise a family.

"It's making a conscious choice that actively shapes the



LEFT: Claudia Schick working out.

BOTTOM: Jespresso girls Samantha Harries - Markham, Jess Gough and Charlotte Donnelly.

future of the town," she said. Jespresso Coffee co-owner Jess Gough said when people support local, the money will stay in the community.

"I can support the community that supports me. From various

junior sports to local events. Jespresso is built on community connections and support," she said.

Every dollar spent locally supports local jobs, local families and a stronger local community.



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When you shop local,
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Every dollar you spend in Wellington supports local businesses and services that directly give back to our community.

From junior sports to arts programs, to community events and fundraisers. When you shop local, everyone benefits.

Shop Local. Grow Local.

"When you shop and support local you are supporting a family and their dream not just the bottom line"

"It's a compound effect - when you spend and support locally it builds confidence for more businesses to back our town"

SAVVI the Label, Wellington

**DUBBO REGION
CONNECT**



Rivercare launch attracts new group of volunteers



Scan the QR code
on your phone or device
to view our new website

Wellington & District
LEADER



Lions bookstore grand opening

THE LONG-AWAITED Wellington Lions Preloved Book Fair grand opening took place last Saturday at its new location in the heart of the CBD.

The Book Fair's new address is 9-10 Nanima Crescent and all the important dignitaries were there for the occasion including Federal Member for Calare Andrew Gee, State member for Dubbo and Wellington Dugald Saunders, Mayor Josh Black with deputy mayor Phillip Toynton, plus many Wellingtonians and other from surrounds.

Now in a larger, more easily accessible location, more books, DVDs/CDs and games are now on sale for visitors buying their next great literary find.

During the ceremony, Wellington Lions were also presented with a new jockey wheel and a bucket of goodies for the club's new food van, donated by Repco Dubbo.

Lions wish to extend a large heartfelt thank you to all the volunteers who helped move the book fair to its new location.

Without their help, the re-opening would not be possible.

The moving of all the stock and setting up of the new shop was completed in just two weeks, due to those massive efforts.

Lions also wish to thank the owners of the historic Kimbell's Kitchen building for their support and use of the shop during the past 12 months.

The Wellington Lions Pre-Loved Book Fair is open Thursday, Friday and Saturday, whenever the lights are on, across from the Commonwealth Bank. Walk in to find your next great read.



Library open day reading relay

JOIN WELLINGTON Library next Thursday (July 30) for Library and Information Week.

It's an 'open day' reading relay.

Simply book a 20-minute session during the day, settle into the Library's designated reading nook in

the Garden room and enjoy reading to keep the relay going.

Call in or phone 02 6801 4501 to reserve your space.

Remember – open doors; open book; open minds.

Man charged with traffic and firearm offences after pursuit

A MAN was been charged with traffic and firearm offences after a pursuit in Wellington on Sunday.

About 9.40pm officers from Orana Mid Western Police District were patrolling the Mitchell Highway, Wellington, when they sighted a Toyota sedan with no taillights on.

Officers have attempted to stop the sedan on Truman Avenue; however, when the vehicle allegedly failed to stop as directed, a pursuit was initiated.

The pursuit continued through several streets in Wellington before turning onto the Mitchell Highway.

Officers continued to pursue the sedan onto Maryvale Road, which becomes a dirt road, and the driver allegedly began to throw items from the sedan.

Police had lost sight of the sedan on the dirt road and terminated the pursuit.

Following a continued search of the area, police located the sedan in a paddock.

The driver – a 29-year-old man – ran from the sedan, and after a foot pursuit, was arrested.

Following a search of the sedan, officers allegedly located and seized two rifles and several rounds of ammunition.

Officers also searched the man and a bag in his possession and allegedly located housebreaking implements, ammunition, methylamphetamine and registration plates.

The man was taken to Wellington Police Station and charged with:

- * Possess unauthorised firearm (two counts),
- * Possess unregistered firearm – not pistol/prohibited firearm (two counts),
- * Possess ammunition without holding licence/permit/authority,
- * Police pursuit – not stop – drive dangerously,
- * Class C motor vehicle exceed speed more than 45km/h – estimated,
- * Possess prohibited drug,
- * Possess housebreaking implements.

He man was refused bail to appear at Bail Division Court 4 on Monday, July 20.



Skye-Rhiannon Veech and Ash Toynton with their thank you plaque from Lions.

Yoga Classes first and third Sunday each month

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In Their Sights



Fashions Mount Rifle Club results for Saturday, July 18.

Hunting Class: S. King 98.8, L. Hough 93.5, E. Gollan 89.2, R. Dowton 77, D. Gollan 49. **500 Yards:** S. King 108.7, J. Pirie 106.1, L. Hough 106.ext
Shoot Saturday, August 1 600 Yards. **The Rifleman**

Annual household chemical cleanout this August

Firearm business hanging on a thread

THE ANNUAL household chemical clean out will take place on Saturday 8 and Sunday 9 August in Wellington and Dubbo.

Mayor Josh Black said the annual clean out was a great opportunity for residents to clean out their garage or shed and dispose of those unwanted household chemicals or paint for free.

“The clean out allows residents to safely dispose of household chemical products, such as household cleaners, pool chemicals and pesticides safely to help protect the environment around us,” Clr Black said.

Items that can be disposed of during the clean out include garden and pool chemicals, household cleaners, hobby chemicals, poisons, batteries, paint, motor oils, fluids and fuels, fluoro lights, gas bottles,

fire extinguishers and smoke detectors.
The annual household chemical cleanout will be held at Wellington Waste and Recycling Centre on Nanima Village Rd on Sunday, August 9 from 11am until 2pm.
“If you are unable to make the annual household chemical clean out event, residents can also drop off these items to the Wellington Waste Transfer Station during their business hours at no charge,” Clr Black said.
Only domestic household quantities are accepted with 20L or 20kg the maximum container size.
The service is not available for businesses or commercial quantities.
For more details on what can be dropped off at the collection points visit www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au

Cabonne community survey

CABONNE COUNCIL has launched a community survey and is encouraging residents to complete.
Based on Council’s current financial position, together with ageing infrastructure, it has been determined that current service levels are unsustainable.
Together with the community, Council must make some difficult decisions and compromises to shape the future.
Council is asking for community members’help to guide this process

by sharing their opinions.
* What Council should prioritise
* Which services are most important
* Where spending should increase, stay the same or decrease
* How we can best shape Cabonne’s future
Some of the questions involve real trade-offs because resources are limited. Feedback will help Council understand what the community values most.
Complete the survey and help shape the future of Cabonne.

Top up for Burrendong Dam

WATER New South Wales said Burrendong Dam would not meet demands for spring and summer if the agency doesn’t top it up.
It’s planning to make a bulk water transfer from Windamere Dam to Burrendong via the Cudgegong River later this year.
Head of Planning Ashley Webb

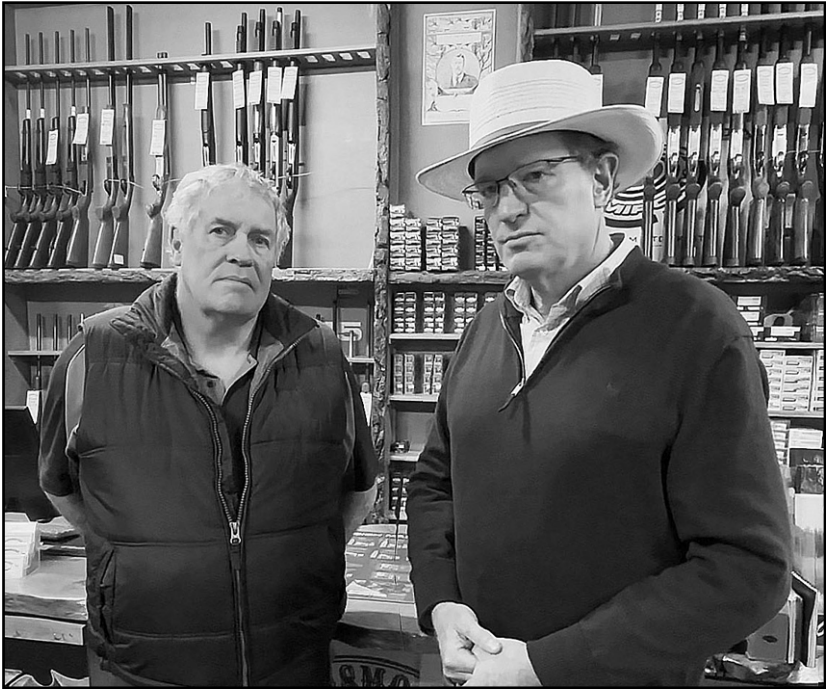
said at least 70-gigalitres would be left in Windamere... which is enough to supply its towns and industries for several years.
He said recent rainfall had not been enough to sufficiently fill the dam.
An information session on the water transfer was held at Club Mudgee on Tuesday.

The price of a ‘Leader’ is just half the cost of a coffee

I RECENTLY met with Jeff from a local Firearm business, who told me the new gun laws have made trade the quietest he has seen in 28 years.
He told me that 70 per cent of gun shops are likely to go under, with many not predicted to last past Christmas.
City people and lawmakers have no appreciation for why people need firearms in country areas - and it’s largely to keep food on our supermarket shelves.
The Government should be going after the illegal firearms, the crooks and the terrorists and working out how people on a terrorist watch list that had travelled to extremist hotspots slipped through the net and were able to carry out these horrific crimes.
Right now, there’s no word on when this buy-back is coming, no money in the budget and zero plan.
It has left small businesses battling to survive and hanging on by a thread.
What is the plan here State and Federal governments?
This is not good enough.



The Gee Report
Andrew Gee
Federal Member for Calare



Grants for Multicultural Festivals and Events
Applications for grants of \$5K-\$20k are available to help organisations deliver multicultural events

held between 1 October 2026 and 30 September 2027.
Apply by 4pm, 13 July link: bit.ly/stronger-together-events-festivals

Did you know 82% of people say

PRINT ADS are STILL the most

trusted form of advertising

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with **Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld**



NOT SURE if you heard, but Telstra recently had an outage on its mobile network.
I know... you probably did hear about it.
It was one of those rare events that quickly became a national talking point.
I was in a radio studio very early that morning, preparing for a regular tech segment.
Before leaving home, I’d received a text message from a friend. It wasn’t until I was sitting in the studio that I tried replying.
Nothing. The message simply wouldn’t send. I tried again with the same result before the interview began.
Then the presenter casually mentioned that Telstra’s network was down.
It now made sense.
The reason I’d received the original text at home was because my phone was still connected to my home Wi-Fi. Once I’d left the house, my phone was relying entirely on the mobile network.
It’s reassuring that my first reaction wasn’t to assume the entire network had failed. Normally we would blame the phone.
We toggle airplane mode. We restart the

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handset. We wonder what we did wrong.
It says something about just how reliable modern mobile networks have become. They’re so dependable that when something does go wrong, it’s almost unimaginable.
According to Telstra’s explanation, this wasn’t the result of hackers or damaged equipment.
Instead, it was caused by a software defect affecting systems that keep different parts of the mobile network synchronised.
Modern mobile networks rely on extraordinary precision, with thousands of components needing to agree on timing to authenticate phones, route calls and deliver data.
When that timing is disrupted, the network itself begins to stumble.
As frustrating as this outage was, it also joins a surprisingly long list of technology failures Australians have experienced over the years.
Back in 2008, a major fibre cable cut caused widespread disruption for Optus customers across parts of Queensland.

In 2016, Telstra experienced several nationwide mobile outages linked to software issues.
In 2017, an outage at Amazon’s Sydney cloud infrastructure affected thousands of Australian websites and online services.
In 2021, many Australians suddenly found Facebook, Instagram and WhatsApp had vanished for around six hours.
Then came the major Optus outage in 2023, followed by the 2024 CrowdStrike software update that grounded flights, disrupted supermarkets, hospitals, broadcasters and businesses around the world.
The interesting trend is that the causes have changed.
Years ago, outages were often the result of someone accidentally digging through a fibre cable or a piece of hardware failing.
Today, the biggest disruptions increasingly come from software. The infrastructure is still there. But a tiny defect in millions of lines of software can ripple across the entire planet in minutes.
Two decades ago, a telecommunications

outage lasting several hours might have gone largely unnoticed. Today, even a disruption lasting minutes can have significant consequences because so much of modern life depends on being connected.
Our phones are no longer just phones.
They’re wallets, navigation systems, authentication devices, boarding passes, business tools and our connection to family, friends and emergency services.
We barely notice the technology when it’s working, but the moment it stops, everyday life quickly becomes much more difficult.
The reality is that outages will happen again. Not just at Telstra, but somewhere, sometime. No network, cloud platform or software system is immune from failure.
The challenge isn’t expecting perfection. It’s recognising that the digital infrastructure we’ve built our lives around has become every bit as important as roads, electricity and water.
The more we depend on it, the more resilient it needs to be, and the more we need to make sure we have a plan B.

Two safety incidents on Scabbing Flat Bridge has Geurie community demanding a funded commitment to a new Scabbing Flat Bridge in the State 2027–28 Budget

Geurie demands meetings with two NSW Ministers after bridge incidents

FOLLOWING TWO recent safety incidents on the century-old Scabbing Flat Bridge, the Scabbing Flat Bridge Action Group (SFBAG) has written to two NSW Ministers requesting face-to-face meetings before August 31.

Association President Michelle Tomkins said the Association was sharing full details of both incidents so bridge users can make their own informed decisions.

“There have been a couple of incidents involving the Scabbing Flat Bridge which have members of the community raising concerns about its safety.

“I want to be completely transparent, so that users of the bridge can make their own decisions on whether they feel safe using it,” Ms Tomkins said.

Incident one: dropped timber during repairs

The first incident occurred during the replacement of bridge timber recently identified as damaged. While the new timber was being secured, it dropped.

A Transport for NSW safety system in place at the time prevented the timber from falling to the ground, and no one was hurt.

The Transport for NSW site team reported the incident to SafeWork as part of its safety process, and the project team paused that stage of the work until SafeWork’s investigation is complete, moving on to other aspects of the maintenance in the meantime.

“The Association notes the incident raises a troubling question: why was the damaged timber not identified in the initial assessment or has the bridge continued to deteriorate over the past three years while maintenance has been under way?” Ms Tomkins said.

Incident two: tyre destroyed by protruding bolt

In the second incident, on June 27, local Ponto resident Helen Frankham narrowly avoided serious injury when she was driving to Dubbo.

As she was midway across the bridge, her front left tyre was ruptured by a bolt protruding from the bridge deck.

A bolt that secures boards to the bridge. Mrs Frankham, an experienced driver, kept control of the vehicle and manoeuvred it safely off the bridge.

The tyre was not repairable, and Transport for NSW has agreed to pay compensation of \$300 to replace the tyre.

Her husband, Evan Frankham, who photographed the bolt, said the outcome could have been far worse.



“My wife had a near miss today but fortunately avoided a major accident.

“The potential of losing control of the vehicle on the bridge could have been catastrophic and could have affected our family’s life forever.

“An out of control vehicle on the bridge is also a major hazard for the bridge workers.” Mr Frankham said.

What if this was a school bus? Local farmer and grazier Claire Booth, a mother of two young children, said the bridge’s heritage status appeared to be standing between the community and a replacement.

“It seems to me a school bus tyre could easily run into a bolt on this bridge,” she said.

If Evan Frankham says he is deeply relieved

his wife kept control of the car, the mind quickly goes to the worst case... what happens if it was the local school bus? Would the driver have been able to keep control of the bus?

“The message seems clear, the heritage protection of a 1907 bridge, designed for the days of the horse and cart, is being put ahead of the safety of children in the Central West of NSW.

“When the safety of our children and their right to a safe school bus journey becomes a political plaything, it is a very sad day for NSW,” Mrs Booth said.

Children attend primary and high schools in Dubbo, Wellington and Geurie that catch school buses that traverse the Geurie bridge. Time for action – meeting with Ministers sought

The Association has requested a meeting with Minister for Roads and Minister for Regional Transport, Jenny Aitchison, to put three practical asks:

1. An interim safe crossing. A temporary modular side-track bridge (a Bailey or panel bridge on a parallel alignment), a measure Transport for NSW and its contractors install routinely, so school buses, freight and residents have a safe crossing while repairs continue.
2. A published end date. A clear public timeline for the current maintenance program, which has run for nearly three years with no stated finish.
3. A funded replacement.

A funded commitment to a new Scabbing Flat Bridge in the 2027–28 NSW Budget.

SFBAG has also requested a meeting with the Minister for Heritage Penny Sharpe, to seek one assurance: that heritage considerations attached to the 1907 timber bridge be removed immediately.

Michelle Tomkins said the community had tried in 2025 to obtain answers from both Minister Aitchison and Minister Sharpe.

Back on 17 September 2025 Minister Aitchinson said in her letter to Mayor Josh Black, “Transport for NSW is investigating the possibility of delisting [the Scabbing Flat Bridge] from [the] Section 170 Register”.

Nothing has happened since Aitchinson’s letter of 17 September 2025.

“There is no end in sight, and these recent safety incidents were a timely reminder to all that nearly a year has passed and the heritage listing is still in place,” Ms Tomkins said.

“We are not asking for anything exotic. A side-track bridge is something Transport for NSW installs as a matter of routine on other projects. An end date is something every road user is entitled to after 968 days of restrictions. And a funded commitment to a new bridge in the 2027–28 Budget is the only answer that fixes the problem.”

968 days of restrictions

By 26 July 2026, it will have been 968 days since the 16-tonne load restriction was original placed on the bridge and serious repairs (and temporary bridge closures) continue since 1 December 2023.

The bridge is a critical crossing for families, farmers and truck drivers, and carries the produce of some 450,000 hectares of prime Central West farmland, which is one of Australia’s most significant agricultural regions.

Alternate routes come at real cost: many are unsuitable for heavy vehicles, and incidents have already occurred on them.

Ms Tomkins said if the Wellington bridge fails, there is no backup bridge access to Dubbo”.

Transport for NSW recently told an NSW Farmers meeting it has no backup strategy for that scenario.

The Association says it expects both ministers to respond with meeting dates before 31 August 2026, and will keep the community informed of their responses.



Andrew GEE MP

INDEPENDENT FEDERAL MEMBER FOR CALARE

Runs on the Board for the Wellington Area

- ✓ \$9.5 million to build a new, purpose built wing focused on dementia and palliative care at Maranatha House
- ✓ \$12 million in disaster funding for the Duke of Wellington Bridge
- ✓ Secured upgrade of Wellington Hospital Emergency Department
- ✓ \$560,000 for Stuart Town water security project
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project Stage Two
- ✓ \$1.1 million for Ponto Falls Road upgrade
- ✓ \$650,000 for upgrades at Wellington Christian School
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project
- ✓ \$2.02 million for replacing the Terrabella, Burrendong and Gundy Creek Bridges
- ✓ \$200,000 for improvements at Kennard Park
- ✓ Video link for Wellington Court House

- ✓ \$26,700 for the Driver Reviver site at the Wellington Information Centre
- ✓ \$1.176 million for improvements at Wellington Caves
- ✓ \$1.5 million for the intergenerational childcare facility at Maranatha House
- ✓ \$1.2 million for security CCTV in Wellington and Calare communities
- ✓ \$50,000 for Wellington Library’s outdoor reading room



✓ \$738,000 for the Cameron Park footbridge

Public Notice

Wellington Hospital Auxiliary
Annual General Meeting
Friday 7 August 2026
Hospital Meeting Room
2 pm
All Welcome to Attend

Water Delivery

Domestic Water Deliveries

Servicing Wellington Region

Fiona: 0427 463 441 Ken: 0427 463 442

Public Notice

Wellington Senior Citizens Club
Annual General Meeting
Thursday 30 July
1.30pm
Seniors Hall Swift Street

Everyone
looks at the
classifieds.

Promote
your
Annual
General
Meetings

Church Services

Anglican Parish of Wellington
WELLINGTON – St John the Baptist Church
Sunday 9am
Sunday 5pm - The Gathering
MARANATHA
11am on 2nd & 4th Friday of month.

Wellington Baptist Church
77 Swift Street
9:30am Sunday mornings
6pm Evening Service

Wellington Uniting Church
Sunday at 9.30am

St Patrick’s Catholic Parish
Saturday
5pm – Mass, St Patrick’s Church, Wellington
8.30am - Stuart Town

Sunday
8am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
10am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval second and fourth Sundays of the month
10am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
8am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington second and fourth Sundays of the month

Weekday mass
Please check parish bulletin

In Christ Chapel
2pm Sunday

We’ll fit any size
Phone
0407 935 998

Jo’s one of our “Hidden Treasures”



STATE MEMBER Dubbo and Wellington, Dugald Saunders, was in town last week to catch up with Wellington’s Jo Ivey who was recognised on the 2025 Hidden Treasures Honour Roll.
As a talented photographer, Jo is known for her ability to capture the true essence of what it means to be part of the community through the pictures she takes of local sporting teams, school events, community organisations and not-for-profit activities.
While she may think she’s hidden behind her camera lens, Jo’s warmth and genuine love for all, radiates throughout Wellington, making her a dearly loved and respected citizen that no one wants hidden.
When she’s not out and about taking photos, Jo can often be found in her kitchen making one of her 4 staples for either a community fundraiser or her family: lasagne, chicken wings, rissoles or pumpkin soup.
Jo has been a regular photographic contributor to the ‘*Leader*’ from our first edition in 2021, and has won a Country Press NSW photo award.

Around the electorate with our State Member Dugald Saunders

Hidden Treasure
A massive CONGRATULATIONS to Wellington’s Jo Ivey for being recognised on the 2025 Hidden Treasures Honour Roll! As a talented photographer, Jo is known for her ability to capture the true essence of what it means to be part of the community through the pictures she takes of local sporting teams, school events, community organisations and not-for-profit activities.
See story and photo above.
The Hidden Treasures Honour Roll recognises the important volunteer roles women and girls play within regional, rural and remote NSW communities. Nominations for the 2026 Roll close 31 December.
For more, visit: bit.ly/HiddenTreasures-HonourRoll

Cultural Centre blow
Last week Dubbo Regional Council (DRC) announced Dubbo’s long awaited Wiradjuri Cultural Tourism Centre has been halted after all construction tenders came in above budget.
8 THURSDAY, JULY 23, 2026, WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER

While DRC has committed to reassessing the project over the coming 12-months, this is a disappointing update to a project that has already been in the works since the first funding deed was signed in 2020.
Our region has a right to know when we can actually expect to see something happening.
Council has already approved the site; a combined \$15 million in funding has been committed by DRC and the State and Federal Governments; all DRC has to do is figure out how they’ll use the money so that we don’t waste six years of planning and opportunity to end up with nothing.

Don’t be alarmed
In October, the Australian Government is launching AusAlert – a new national warning system that uses the latest technology to send localised emergency messages to compatible mobile phones, tablets and smart watches.
But before AusAlert is ready to launch, the system needs to be tested.
A national test will take place at 2pm

AEST, Monday 27 July 2026.
At the time of the test, a single ‘Critical’ AusAlert message will be sent to every compatible mobile device in Australia.
* Everyone with a compatible phone or other device in Australia can expect to receive the alert.
* Devices will vibrate and play a siren-like warning sound for about 10 seconds.
* An AusAlert message will appear on device screens. It will clearly say it is a test, but exactly how it appears will depend on your device type and operating system.
* You can turn off ‘Priority’ AusAlerts using your device settings, but you cannot turn off ‘Critical’ AusAlerts.
You don’t need to do anything in response to the test, but you can provide feedback at <https://www.ausalert.gov.au/feedback>
IMPORTANT: If the test could disrupt you or cause you or a loved one to feel unsafe, turn off your mobile devices or switch them to aeroplane mode before the scheduled test time, and leave them off for at least one hour.
The National Emergency Management Agency is delivering the system in partner-

ship with the relevant federal, state and territory agencies. Once launched it will be used by emergency services to send warnings about local or widespread hazards, disasters and other emergencies.

Petition made easier
We need more overtaking lanes between Wellington and Dubbo, and there’s currently a petition open calling for just that.
To make it easier for locals to sign the petition, the following businesses are kindly displaying a QR code which links directly to the petition website:
* PitStop Garage Geurie;* The Lemon Tree Café,* Geurie General Store,* Ron Stubbsfield Toyota,* Jespresso Coffee Co.
* Cusacks Butchery;* Wellington Lions Pre-loved Book Store
You can also sign the petition by following the prompts on my Facebook and Instagram pages or my website at www.dugaldsaunders.com.au

Until next time, Dugald



Rebecca Reardon elected as new NSW Farmers president



MOREE FARMER Rebecca Reardon has been elected as the new President of the NSW Farmers Association.

Mrs Reardon is actively involved, with her husband Dan, in their mixed grain and livestock farming business, and brings extensive commercial sector experience to the role.

She has over 20 years in leadership roles for agribusiness companies, specialising in supply chain management and international and domestic commodity marketing in grains and fertilisers.

Mrs Reardon has been in the role of NSW Farmers vice-president for the past four years.

She is also deeply involved in all aspects of the Moree community where she and husband Dan have raised their three children.

“My inspiration for stepping into this role is to get agriculture in NSW and NSW Farmers Association in a stronger place for the next generation,” Mrs Reardon said.

“If farmers and rural communities don’t have a voice, they’ll be dealt a poorer hand.”

Rebecca is a Graduate of the AICD and holds an Honors degree in Agricultural Economics.

Brocklesby grain grower and livestock producer Justin Everitt was elected as incoming NSW Vice-President.

Mr Everitt and wife Kate produce wheat, canola, barley, lupins, wool and prime lambs and trade cattle on a generational family farm.

Primarily focused on grains production, Mr Everitt is recognised as a leader in the grains industry, serving as chair of the NSW Farmers Grains Committee since 2021.

Goolma Road and Mitchell Highway intersection upgrade ready for windfarm blades



TURBINE BLADES will soon be delivered to Squadron Energy’s Uungula Wind Farm following the completion of the Goolma Road and Mitchell Highway intersection upgrade.

The work involved widening the turn from Mitchell Highway onto Goolma Road, enabling long trucks to make a gradual turn into the road while carrying 80-metre, 35-tonne blades.

Previously, vehicles entering Goolma Road were required to take a sharp turn, making access impractical for oversized trucks.

Squadron Energy Uungula Wind Farm Project Director Sanjay Goel said the upgrade was an important development that would improve the road network and enable the next phase of construction.

“The upgrade has transformed an intersection that was previously unsuitable for oversized vehicles into one that can safely accommodate turbine blade deliveries to Uungula Wind Farm,” Mr Goel said.

“This has been carefully planned to ensure we can transport these large components safely while minimising impacts for local road users.

“With blade deliveries set to begin soon, this milestone brings us another step closer to seeing turbines erected across the wind farm.”

Work on the intersection began in May, following the completion of the nearby Goolma Road and Twelve Mile Road intersection upgrade in March.

Both upgrades were carried out by Divall’s Earthmoving and Bulk Haulage.

Blade delivery for Uungula Wind Farm began this week and will continue daily except Sundays up to August 8 pending logistical checks and approvals.

Transport company ARES is carrying out component deliveries for wind turbine supplier, GE Vernova.

Monday 27 July

2:00 PM

National Test

!

Introducing AusAlert™

Designed to send emergency alerts in times of local and national disaster.

When a disaster strikes, staying informed helps keep you safe.

!

We'll be sending a test alert to your mobile device

Around 2 pm on Monday 27 July 2026, we'll be testing AusAlert as part of the national rollout.

To learn more, visit ausalert.gov.au

AusAlert helps keep you informed

Authorised by the Australian Government, Canberra

 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 Hard Quiz. 10.30 Spicks And Specks. 11.00 New Zealand Spy. 11.25 Bad Company. Final. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 Believe Me. 2.00 Back Roads. 2.30 Julia Zemiro's Home Delivery. 3.00 Fake Or Fortune? 4.00 Frankie Drake Mysteries. 4.45 Long Lost Family. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 Back Roads. 8.30 Grand Designs. 9.15 Treasure & Dirt. 10.15 Twenty Twenty Six. Final. 10.50 ABC Late News. 11.05 The Business. 11.20 Frankie Drake Mysteries. 12.05 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Room For Improvement. 2.30 Air Crash Investigations: The Accident Files. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 RSPCA Animal Rescue. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Father Brown. 8.30 Grace. 10.30 Murdoch Mysteries. 11.30 Late Programs.
 3.35pm Would I Lie To You? 4.05 MythBusters. 5.00 Phil Spencer: Secret Agent Specials. 5.45 Grand Designs: House Of The Year. 6.35 Richard Osman's House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 Hard Quiz. 9.05 Gruen. 9.40 Late Programs.

 6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show. 12.00 Seven's National News At Noon. 1.00 Beat The Chasers UK. 2.00 Bridge Of Lies. 3.00 The Chase. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6:30. 7.00 Home And Away. 8.30 Air Crash Investigations. 9.30 Homicide: With Ron Iddles. 10.30 Unbelievable Moments Caught On Camera. 11.30 Motorway Patrol. 12.00 Brave New World. 1.30 Harry's Practice. 2.00 Home Shopping. 4.00 NBC Today. 4.45 Glasgow 2026 Commonwealth Games: Opening Ceremony.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 1.30 Highway Patrol. 2.30 The Force: Investigate The Line. 3.30 Tougher In Alaska. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers: Best Of. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.00 Football. AFL. Adelaide v Collingwood. 10.30 AFL Post-Game Show. 11.00 Kick Ons. 11.30 Late Programs.
 6.00 Kids' Programs. 4.20 Santiago Of The Seas. 5.30 Talking Tom Heroes. 5.55 PJ Masks Power Heroes. 6.45 HexVets And Magic Pets. 7.05 Batwheels. 7.40 Ninjago: Dragons Rising. 8.05 Young Sheldon. 8.30 Young Sheldon. 8.50 Ultimate Vets. 9.10 Animal Park. 10.10 Secrets Of The Zoo. 10.55 Late Programs.

 6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 Tipping Point: Celebrity Families. 1.15 Getaway. 1.45 My Way. 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Rugby League. NRL. Eels v Penrith Panthers. 9.55 NRL Thursday Night Footy Post-Match. 10.40 9News Late. 11.10 Bad Blood. 12.10 Tipping Point. 1.00 Next Stop. 1.30 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 2.30 Global Shop. 3.00 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 4.00 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 The Great Day Out. 10.30 My Kitchen Rules. 12.00 The Good Doctor. 3.00 A Moveable Feast. 3.30 The Food Dude. 4.00 Extended Family. 4.30 St. Denis Medical. 5.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 Ramsay's Kitchen Nightmares USA. 9.30 Ramsay's Kitchen Hell. 10.30 First Dates UK. 11.30 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 ABC News Afternoons. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.45 The Business. 9.00 The World. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.30 Foreign Correspondent. 11.00 ABC Nightly News. 11.30 Late Programs.

 6.00 Morning Programs. 8.00 Lingo. 9.00 The Finish Line. 10.00 Entertainment Tonight. 10.20 MasterChef Australia. 11.30 Farm To Fork. 12.00 Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. 12.30 Family Feud. 1.00 10 News: Lunchtime. 2.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 2.30 The Finish Line. 3.30 Lingo. 4.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 10 News+. 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 7.30 NCIS: Sydney. 8.30 NCIS. 9.30 10's Late News. 10.30 The Big Bang Theory. 11.30 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 9.30 The Living Room. 10.30 Building The Dream. 11.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 JAG. 3.30 Bull. 4.30 JAG. 6.30 Bull. 7.30 NCIS. 8.30 Law & Order: SVU. 9.25 Boston Blue. 10.20 Blue Bloods. 11.15 JAG. 12.15 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 11.30 My Favorite Martian. 12.00 As Time Goes By. 1.10 Midsomer Murders. 3.10 Antiques Roadshow. 3.40 MOVIE: Holiday On The Buses. (1973) 5.30 Yorkshire Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 RBT. 8.30 Emergency. 9.30 A+E After Dark. 10.30 Chicago Med. 11.30 Late Programs.

 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 Going Places With Ernie Dingo. 3.30 The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. 4.00 Michael Mosley Secrets Of The Superagers. 5.00 Cycling. Tour de France. H'lights. 6.00 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.35 Spain With Michael Portillo. 8.30 Eva Longoria: Searching For France. 9.20 Cycling. Tour de France. 2.00 Anne Boleyn. 3.00 Michael Mosley Secrets Of The Superagers. 3.55 Ireland In Music: Scilpinni. 5.00 NHK World English News Morning. 5.30 ANC Philippines The World Tonight.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 10.30 Becker. 11.00 Frasier. 12.00 Lingo. 1.00 Friends. 3.00 Frasier. 4.00 Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. 4.30 Becker. 5.00 The Big Bang Theory. 6.00 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 The Cheap Seats. 11.00 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 Cycling. Tour de France. H'lights. 4.05 WorldWatch. 6.10 Mysteries From Above. 7.05 Jeopardy! 7.35 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. 8.30 History's Greatest Mysteries. 9.20 The UnBelievable With Dan Aykroyd. 10.10 Alone Australia. 11.20 The Expanse. 12.15 Late Programs.

 6.00 News Breakfast. 9.00 ABC News Mornings. 10.00 Compass. 10.30 Stuff The British Stole. 11.00 Race Around The World. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 Portrait Artist Of The Year. 1.50 Treasure & Dirt. 3.00 Fake Or Fortune? 3.55 Murdoch Mysteries. 4.45 Long Lost Family. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 Monty Don's Rhineland Gardens. New. 8.30 Saint-Pierre. 9.15 Spicks And Specks. 9.50 Would I Lie To You? 10.15 ABC Late News. 10.35 New Zealand Spy. 11.00 Murdoch Mysteries. 11.45 Rage New Music. 5.00 Rage.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 The Great Australian Doorstep. 2.30 Sydney Weekender. 3.00 Feel Good Road Trips. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 RSPCA Animal Rescue. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 The Americas. 8.30 Escape To The Country. 11.30 Late Programs.
 1.15pm Beyond Paradise. 2.15 ER. 3.00 QI. 3.30 Would I Lie To You? 4.00 MythBusters. 4.50 The Piano UK. 5.40 Grand Designs: House Of The Year. 6.30 Richard Osman's House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 MOVIE: No Strings Attached. (2011) 10.15 Late Programs.

 6.00 Glasgow 2026 Commonwealth Games: Opening Ceremony Continued. 7.00 Sunrise. 9.30 The Morning Show. 12.00 Seven's National News At Noon. 1.00 Glasgow 2026 Commonwealth Games: Opening Ceremony Highlights. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6:30. 7.00 Glasgow 2026 Commonwealth Games. Day 1: Evening. 8.30 Glasgow 2026 Commonwealth Games. Day 1: Night. 10.00 Glasgow 2026 Commonwealth Games. Day 1: Late. 12.00 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 Timbersports. 3.30 Tougher In Alaska. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.00 AFL: Friday Night Countdown. 7.30 Football. AFL. Melbourne v Geelong. 10.40 MOVIE: Death Wish. (1974) 12.45 Late Programs.
 6.00 Kids' Programs. 5.30 Talking Tom Heroes. 5.55 PJ Masks Power Heroes. 6.45 HexVets And Magic Pets. 7.05 Gardening Australia Junior. 7.35 Star Wars: Young Jedi Adventures. 8.00 Be Cool, Scooby-Doo! 8.50 Steven Universe. 9.40 MythBusters "There's Your Problem!". 10.30 Merlin. 11.15 Late Programs.

 6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 MOVIE: The PA And The Manhattan Prince. (2023) 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Rugby League. NRL. South Sydney Rabbitohs v Melbourne Storm. 9.55 NRL Friday Night Footy Post-Match. 10.45 MOVIE: Death Wish V. (1994) Charles Bronson. 12.40 Resident Alien. 1.30 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 4.00 Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. 4.30 Global Shop. 5.00 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.30 A Moveable Feast. 3.30 The Food Dude. 4.00 Emergency Call. 4.30 Anh Does Vietnam. 5.30 First Dates UK. 6.30 MOVIE: Trolls Band Together. (2023) 8.30 MOVIE: Forgetting Sarah Marshall. (2008) Jason Segel, Kristen Bell. 10.50 MOVIE: You Don't Mess With The Zohan. (2008) 1.10 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 News. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 Kitchen Cabinet. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.35 If You're Listening. 9.00 The World. 9.30 Foreign Correspondent. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.30 Late Programs.

 6.00 Morning Programs. 8.00 Lingo. 9.00 The Finish Line. 10.00 Entertainment Tonight. 10.20 MasterChef Australia. 11.30 Farm To Fork. 12.00 Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. 12.30 Family Feud. 1.00 10 News: Lunchtime. 2.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 2.30 The Finish Line. 3.30 Lingo. 4.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 10 News+. 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 7.30 Love It Or List It Australia. 8.40 Have You Been Paying Attention? 9.40 10's Late News. 10.40 The Big Bang Theory. 11.30 Late Programs.
 6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Days Of Our Lives. 8.45 The Young And The Restless. 9.30 The Living Room. 10.30 Building The Dream. 11.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 JAG. 3.30 Bull. 4.30 JAG. 6.30 Bull. 7.30 NCIS. 10.20 Bull. 11.15 JAG. 1.15 Home Shopping.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.15 Antiques Roadshow. 3.45 MOVIE: Will Any Gentleman...? (1953) 5.30 Yorkshire Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 Find My Country House Australia. Return. 8.30 MOVIE: Spectre. (2015) Daniel Craig, Christoph Waltz. 11.25 Late Programs.

 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 NITV News: Nula. 3.30 The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. 4.00 Michael Mosley Secrets Of The Superagers. 5.00 Cycling. Tour de France. H'lights. 6.00 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.35 The Quest For Camelot. 8.40 Rebuilding Notre Dame Cathedral Pt 2. 9.50 Cycling. Tour de France. 2.15 The Truth About Anxiety With Celia Pacquola. 3.20 Michael Mosley Secrets Of The Superagers. 4.20 Ireland In Music: Scilpinni. 5.00 NHK World English News Morning. 5.30 ANC Philippines The World Tonight.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 9.00 Family Feud. 10.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 10.30 Becker. 11.00 Frasier. 12.00 Lingo. 1.00 Friends. 3.00 Frasier. 4.00 Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. 4.30 Becker. 5.00 The Big Bang Theory. 6.00 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 Cycling. Tour de France. H'lights. 4.05 WorldWatch. 6.05 Inside The Huddle. 6.35 Over The Black Dot. 7.05 Jeopardy! 7.35 Big Fat Quiz Best Bits: Dream Teams. 8.30 History's Greatest Mysteries. 9.20 The UnBelievable With Dan Aykroyd. 10.10 The Expanse. 11.50 Late Programs.

 6.00 Rage Charts. 7.00 Weekend Breakfast. 9.00 Rage. 10.30 Rage Vault Guest Programmer. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 12.30 Cooper & Fry. 2.00 Saint-Pierre. 3.00 Bill Bailey's Wild West Australia. 3.45 Griff's Canadian Adventure. 4.35 Kitchen Cabinet. 5.05 Australian Story. 5.35 Landline. 6.05 Kath & Kim. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 Cooper & Fry. 9.05 Doc Martin. 9.55 Believe Me. 10.40 Little Disasters. 11.25 Rage.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 1.00 RSPCA Animal Rescue. 1.30 Secrets Of Beautiful Gardens. 2.30 Harry's Practice. 3.00 Horse Racing. Industry Celebration Day and Caulfield Season Finale. 5.00 Dog Patrol. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bondi Vet. 7.30 The Yorkshire Vet. 8.30 Lewis. 10.30 Escape To The Country. 11.30 Late Programs.
 2.05pm ER. 2.50 Penn & Teller: Fool Us. 3.30 QI. 4.00 Would I Lie To You? 4.30 MythBusters. 5.25 The Piano UK. 6.10 Grand Designs: House Of The Year. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 MOVIE: Da Kath & Kim Code. (2005) 9.55 Late Programs.

 6.00 Morning Programs. 7.00 Weekend Sunrise. 10.00 The Morning Show: Weekend. 12.00 Horse Racing. Industry Celebration Day and Caulfield Season Finale. 3.00 Glasgow 2026 Commonwealth Games. Day 1: H'lights. 5.00 Seven News At 5. 5.30 Border Security: Australia's Front Line. 6.00 Seven News. 7.00 Glasgow 2026 Commonwealth Games. Day 2: Evening. 8.30 Glasgow 2026 Commonwealth Games. Day 2: Night. 10.00 Glasgow 2026 Commonwealth Games. Day 2: Late. 12.00 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 1.00 Blokesworld. 1.30 The Car Club. 2.00 Rides Down Under: Workshop Wars. 3.00 Motor Racing. Night Thunder. High Limits World Tour. Replay. 4.00 American Restoration. 4.30 Football. AFL. GWS Giants v Sydney. 7.30 MOVIE: Gladiator. (2000) 10.40 MOVIE: 65. (2023) 12.40 Late Programs.
 6.00 Kids' Programs. 4.50 Gardening Australia Junior. 5.15 MOVIE: Tummy Tom 2: A New Friend For Tummy Tom. (2024) 6.25 Emerald. 7.05 Let's Go Bananas! 7.30 Kids Baking Championship. Final. 8.10 Kids BBQ Championship. 8.55 Chopped Junior. 10.00 Fresh Off The Boat. 10.40 Late Programs.

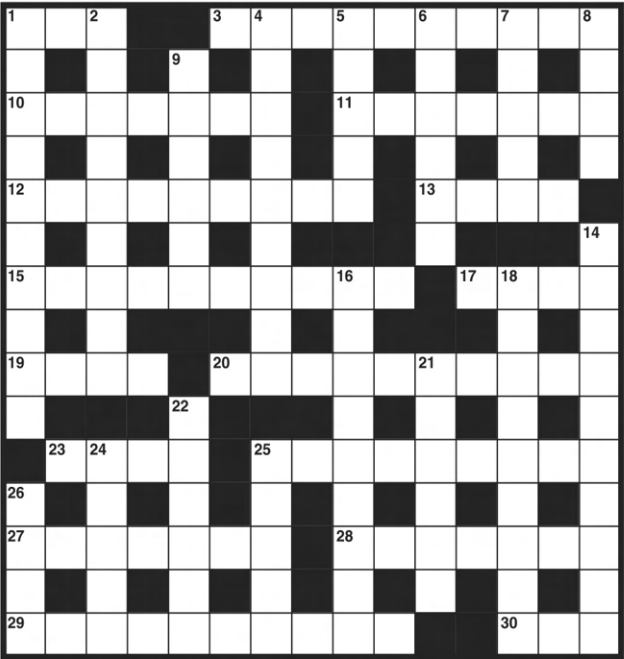
 6.00 Getaway. 6.30 A Current Affair. 7.00 Weekend Today. 10.00 Today Extra: Saturday. 12.00 Great Australian Detour Snow. 12.30 Rugby League. NRL Women's Premiership. Canberra Raiders v Cronulla Sharks. 2.30 NRLW Wrap. 3.15 Rugby League. NRL Women's Premiership. Canterbury Bulldogs v Dragons. 5.00 9News First At Five. 5.30 Getaway. 6.00 9News Saturday. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 MOVIE: Legally Blonde. (2001) Reese Witherspoon. 9.30 MOVIE: Crazy, Stupid, Love. (2011) Steve Carell, Ryan Gosling. 11.50 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 The Great Outdoors. 12.30 Yummy Mummies. 1.30 Zumbo's Just Desserts. 2.45 Australia's Got Talent. 4.30 MOVIE: Spider-Man: Across The Spider-Verse. (2023) 7.30 MOVIE: Spider-Man: No Way Home. (2021) Tom Holland. 10.40 MOVIE: Gunpowder Milkshake. (2021) 12.55 Late Programs.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 News. 3.30 That Pacific Sports Show. 4.00 News. 4.30 Andrew Olle Media Lecture. 5.00 News. 5.30 Asia News Week. 6.00 ABC Evening News. 6.30 Australian Story. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 Back Roads. 8.10 Four Corners. 9.00 ABC Nightly News. 9.30 Compass. 10.00 Late Programs.

 6.00 Morning Programs. 8.00 IFISH. 8.30 All 4 Adventure. 9.30 Frugal Foodie. 10.00 Freshly Picked With Simon Toohey. 10.30 Luca's Key Ingredient. 1.00 Intrepid Adventures. 11.30 Farm To Fork. 12.00 MasterChef Australia. 1.00 Good Food Everyday With Gary Mehigan. Final. 1.30 Next Gen Dairy. 2.00 Deal Or No Deal. 2.30 Millionaire Hot Seat. 3.00 The Finish Line. 4.00 Lingo. 5.00 10 News. 6.30 The Dog House Australia. 7.30 Love It Or List It Australia. 9.50 Ambulance Australia. 10.50 Ambulance UK. 12.00 Late Programs.
 6.00 Home Shopping. 9.00 Reel Action. 9.30 So Help Me Todd. 12.30 The Living Room. 2.30 JAG. 4.30 Reel Action. Return. 5.00 Escape Fishing With ET. 5.30 JAG. 7.30 NCIS. 10.20 Numb3rs. 12.15 JAG. 2.15 Home Shopping.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.30 My Favorite Martian. 11.00 MOVIE: Poison Pen. (1939) 12.35 MOVIE: The Sound Barrier. (1952) 3.00 Rugby Union. Shute Shield. Northern Suburbs v Gordon. 5.00 Rugby League. NRL Women's Premiership. North Qld Cowboys v Titans. 7.00 Customs. 7.30 To Be Advised. 12.00 Late Programs.

 6.00 Morning Programs. 11.00 Cycling. Tour de France. H'lights. 12.00 Cycling. Tour de France. H'lights. 1.00 BBC News At Ten. 1.30 France 24 International News. 2.00 PBS NewsHour. 3.00 Following The Flow. 4.30 Grand Tours Of Scotland's Rivers. 5.30 Cycling. Tour de France. H'lights. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.30 Cycling. Tour de France. 1.00 Underground Army. 2.55 Michael Mosley Secrets Of The Superagers. 3.50 Ireland In Music: Scilpinni. 5.00 NHK World English News Morning. 5.15 Euronews. 5.30 ANC Philippines The World Tonight.
 6.00 Good Chef Bad Chef. 7.00 The Bold And The Beautiful. 9.30 Millionaire Hot Seat. 11.00 Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. 11.30 Ridiculousness. 1.00 Friends. 6.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.30 The Montreal Comedy Festival. 11.30 Ridiculousness. 1.00 Home Shopping.
 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 Cycling. Tour de France. H'lights. 4.05 WorldWatch. 6.05 Mastermind Australia. 6.40 The Mega-Brands That Built The World. 7.30 Record-Breaking Submarines. 8.35 Icons Unearthed: Harrison Ford. New. 9.30 MOVIE: Crossing Over. (2009) 11.30 Late Programs.

 6.00 Rage. 7.00 Weekend Breakfast. 9.00 Insiders. 10.00 Offsiders. 10.30 The World This Week. 11.00 Compass. 11.30 Songs Of P
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CROSSWORD



ACROSS

- 1 Set up (3)
3 Punctuation mark (10)
10 Surgeon's instrument (7)
11 Country in Horn of Africa (7)
12 Long pasta (9)

DOWN

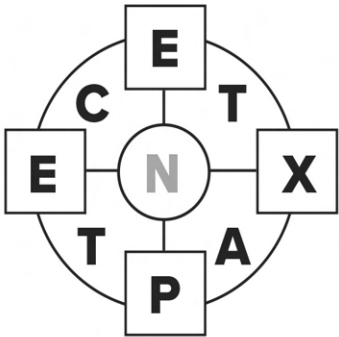
- 13 Prevaricates (4)
15 Patrician (10)
17 Bough (4)
19 Monetary fraction (4)
20 Cross-trainer (10)
23 Edible rootstock (4)
25 Outer layer of skin (9)

9-LETTER

No. 188

Using the nine letters in the grid, how many words of four letters or more can you list? The centre letter must be included and each letter may only be used once. No colloquial or foreign words. No capitalised nouns, apostrophes or plural words ending in "s".

- Today's Aim:
12 words: Good
18 words: Very good
24 words: Excellent



SOLUTION



acne, ante, cane, cant, expectant, extant, extent, nape, neap, neat, next, pane, pant, patent, patent, pecan, peen, pence, pent, tenet, tent

No. 188

WORDFIT

3 LETTERS

- AGE
APE
ARE
ASS
DID
EGG
ERA
FED
GEE
GYM
HOG
ICE
IDS
MEW
NEE
ODD
OHS
OVA
PRO
ROD
SEA
THE
WEE
YET

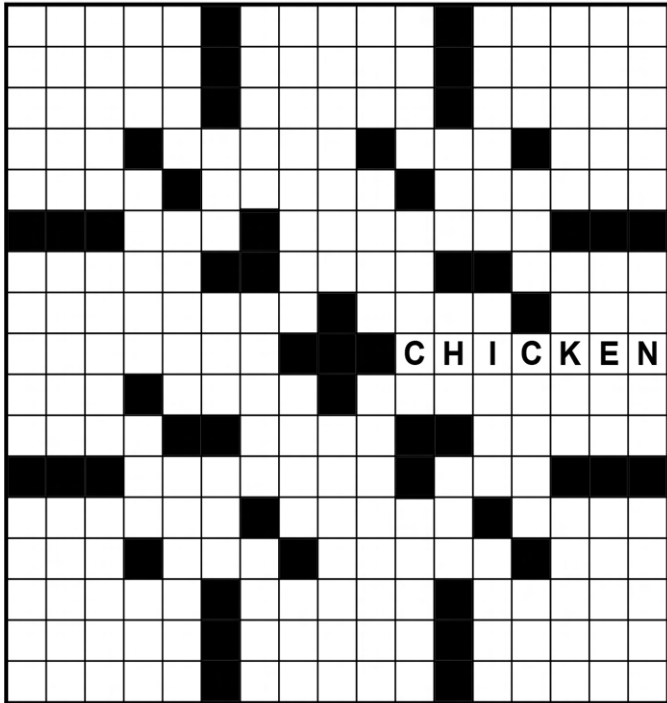
- SAME
SCAB
SECT
SEER
SLID

5 LETTERS

- ABATE
ABIDE
ABOVE
ADAGE
ADDED
ADEPT
ADORE
AGILE
APRIL
BELLS
CAROL
CARTS
CLAMP
COLDS
CREST
DRANK
EDGER
FARCE
GEARS
HASTE
HIRED
KNEES
LILAC
LUTES
MINCE
MOOSE
NIGHT
OPENS
OPERA

4 LETTERS

- ARCS
ARIA
DROP
EDDY
FROM
NEST
PATS
POPE
ROOM



- OUTDO
PITHY
RAKES
REDID
ROBIN
SANER
SCOFF
SEDAN
SENSE
SHONE
SOLES
STEER
SWOOP

- TACOS
TALON
TEPEE
THOSE
TRACE
TROLL
WAFER

7 LETTERS

- CHICKEN
EDITORS
OFTENER
ORDERED
PROLONG
WELFARE

8 LETTERS

- CAUSEWAY
HIDEAWAY
RESOURCE
RESTLESS

6 LETTERS

- COSTED
DEADER
DRAWER
RESETS

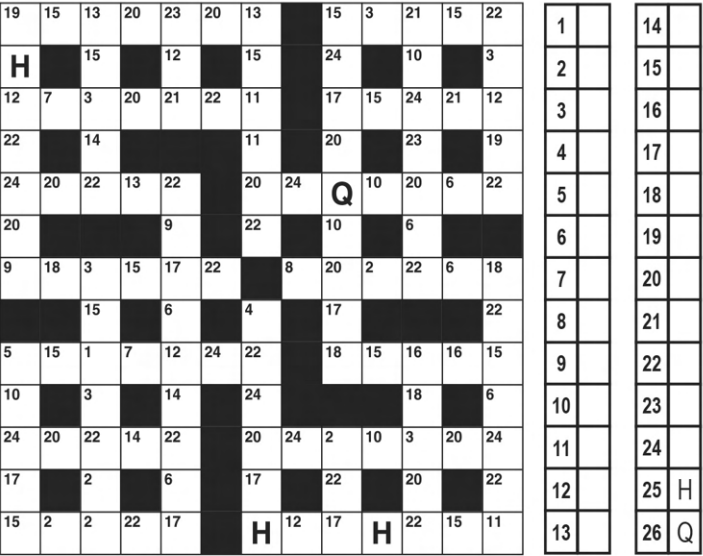
SOLUTION



CODEWORD

No. 138

Each number corresponds to a letter of the alphabet. Two have been filled in for you, can you work out the rest?



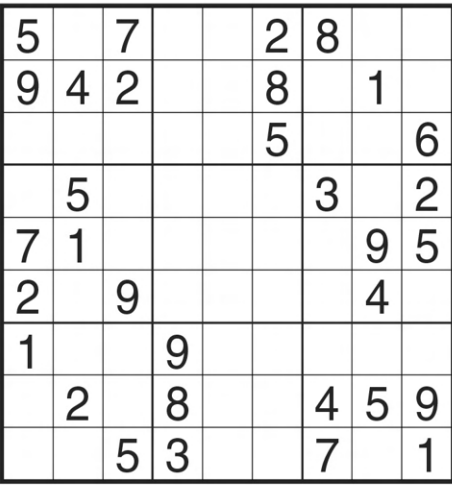
ANSWERS: 1. A little 2. U 3. Four 4. Volleyball 5. George Washington 6. Larry David 7. Germany 8. Station Eleven 9. Emily St. John Mandel 10. 1987

SUDOKU

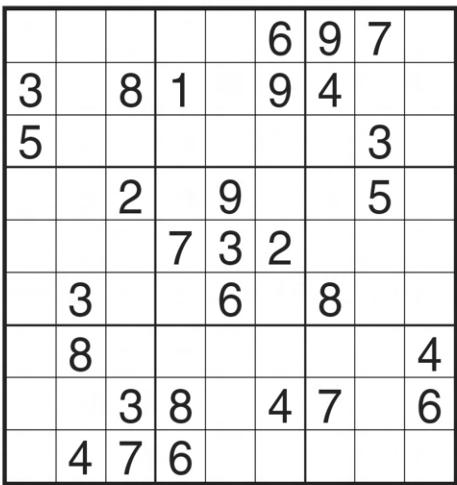
No. 188

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every number from 1 to 9 must appear in: each of the nine vertical columns, each of the nine horizontal rows and each of the nine 3 x 3 boxes. Remember, no number can occur more than once in any row, column or box.

EASY

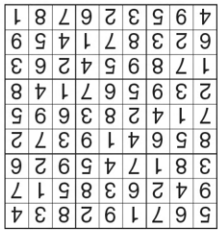


MEDIUM



SOLUTIONS

EASY



MEDIUM



QUICK QUIZ

- What is the dot over the letter i and j called?
- What is the chemical symbol for uranium?
- How many sides does a trapezoid have?
- Double contact, spiking and goofy are terms used in which sport?
- Who is the only US president to be elected unopposed?
- Who, with Jerry Seinfeld, created the TV series *Seinfeld*?
- What country borders Poland to the west?
- Mackenzie Davis (pictured) stars in which 2021 post-apocalyptic TV series?
- And which author wrote the book on which the TV series is based?
- In what year did the *Neighbours* wedding of Scott and Charlene air in Australia?



ANSWERS: 1. A little 2. U 3. Four 4. Volleyball 5. George Washington 6. Larry David 7. Germany 8. Station Eleven 9. Emily St. John Mandel 10. 1987

WORD SEARCH

No. 098

Can you find all the words listed? The leftover letters will spell out a secret message.



- ALADDIN
BART
BEAVIS
CRUELLA
DONALD
DUCK
DORY
EEYORE
FRED
FLINTSTONE
GOKU
GOOFY
HOMER
HOOK
JERRY
MOUSE
JETSONS
LILO
LISA
LUMIERE
MAGGIE
MICKEY
MINNIE
MORTY
NEMO
PETER PAN
PLUTO
POPEYE
RAPUNZEL
RICK
ROCKY
ROGER
RABBIT
RUGRATS
SHREK
SIMPSONS
SMURFS
STIMPY
TOM CAT

SECRET MESSAGE: Where dreams really do come true

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This week will be relatively dry with a few sprinkles on Thursday and possibly Tuesday Wednesday next week, but a very cold week ahead with temperatures hovering around minus 1 to 2 degrees overnight.

Daily market overview

After one of the strongest wheat rallies we’ve seen in months, grain markets paused overnight (17/07) as traders took some profits. With the Australian dollar slipping back below 70 US cents, local grain prices remain well supported.

Chicago September wheat closed 3c down at 675c/US giving back only a small portion of Thursday’s impressive 34c gain. The move back below 70 US cents is supportive for Australian grain markets and should help offset some of the softer offshore futures.

A weaker Australian dollar improves Australia’s export competitiveness and generally provides support to local cash bids, particularly for wheat and barley. indicative local prices: APW1 \$343, bar 1 \$303, CHK 1\$670, CAN1 \$750.

Markets at a glance

Wool. 16th. The EMI closed 1901c/kg clean (-8c), 21,230 bales offered. Sydney Merino fleece pushed down by tender wools, broader wools gained ground finer lots regained some lost ground on day 2, but faulty, off types were irregular. Merino skirtings finer lots with low vm lifted as other types were unchanged on day 1, but drifted lower on day 2. XB firm day 1. Locks and crutchings softened by 30c. NRI closed at 1962c/kg clean, down 6c Sydney’s pass in rate was7.5 % with no bales withdrawn.

CATTLE CTLX.. 14th 1760 head -492. Few pens well-finished young trade cattle, odd pens for feeders..Young trade cattle 10c dearer, vealers and yearlings 530c to 554c/kg. Feeder steers firm, heifers 5c dearer. Feeder steers 480c to 621c/kg, heifers 480c to 549c/kg. Young restocker cattle to strong competition, steers to 659c, heifers to 538c/kg. Grown steers and heifers firm, steers 430c to 480c/kg, heifers 430c to 491c/kg. Heavy cows 4c cheaper, secondary cows 8c dearer. 2&3 score cows 355c to 402c, heavy cows 3 85c to 426c, ave 411c/kg. Cows to restockers 347c to 409c/kg. Heavy bulls to 430c/kg.

SHEEP CTLX.. 15th 1900 sheep -200, 5600 lambs -700. Supply down slightly, quality good across the finished trade and heavy weights, market sold to cheaper trend. Lighter lambs to processors \$242 to \$262, stores \$170 to \$263. Medium and heavy trade \$7 to \$15 cheaper, ave 1200c to 1250c/kg cwt, 23 to 24 kg \$272 to \$310. Heavy lambs \$10 to \$15 easier, ave 1130c to 1215c/kg cwt. Heavy lambs \$300 to \$324. extra heavies \$315 to \$370.

MUTTON numbers down a little, quality varied, prices holding steady. Medium first-cross ewes \$179 to \$215, heavy first-cross ewes \$252 to \$300.

Stock Clearance:— Shed now again accessible after being blocked for eight weeks rail crossing works.

Fertiliser, seed, AG chem, fungicides, fencing, poly pipe, small packs dips, drenches, scales, shelving, some give away products with every \$200 spend. Antiques and furniture.



Dubbo (02) 6885 0549



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WEEKLY MARKET REPORT
Week ending July 17, 2026
AWEX Northern Micron Indices Comparison

AWEX INDEX	This Week \$03/26	This Week M03/26	Last Sale \$02/26	Sydney Change	Last Year Sydney	Sydney Yearly Change
17	2583	2591	2588	-5	1688	+895
18	2522	2495	2498	+24	1600	+922
19	2309	2298	2302	+7	1502	+807
19.5	2219	2222	2226	-7	-	-
20	2148	2151	2162n	-14	1456	+692
21	2113n	2114	-	-	1445n	+668
28	850	832	850n	-	495n	+355
MC	1195n	1162n	1231n	-36	717n	+478

Momentum holds “just there” in small offering

EXPECTATIONS OF a continuation of a slightly stronger market from the previous sale didn’t eventuate in last week’s Australian wool market, with the small 21,230 bale offering not enough to entice buyers into holding the price levels. Whilst the falls were minimal, it does show that the lack of supply driven market that we have experienced recently may have come to an end. Tuesday’s opening had finer Merino indicator a little cheaper, and middle microns slightly stronger. On day two, that trend reversed, with single digit gains and losses appearing. Skirtings were in buyer’s favour, cardings were weaker, and crossbreds also softened, mainly in the 28 micron and broader categories. In US dollar terms the market strengthened by 3 cents, due to a firmer Australian dollar. Industry market reports reflect the values of fleece wool that are 1% vegetable matter or less to create the quotes that we rely upon, with no higher VM fleece or skirting indicator to show their pricing level. Last week price support fell far more for burry fleece types than the indicator types, no doubt influencing the passed in rate. This time of year is traditionally at the lowest volumes of the 1% types, making it more difficult for buyers to deliver those wools to processors. In the past few months the discount on light fault types was minimal, but now buyer’s purchases have become more selective than weakening the market. Well-classed wools with good figures are finding good support, with differences of up to 30-50 cents clean on lots that “fit” buyer’s requirements. Differences can be the position of break in tensile strength, the predicted combing length, the type of vegetable matter, the weight of the lot, the style of the wool such as spinners or top makers, the traditional style verses the bolder modern type, the mulesing status or industry scheme that is associated with the lot can affect how a buyer views and values it. More and more orders are seeking these subtle differences, which shows that growers efforts with management, selection and documentation are now starting to be rewarded more often. This week will be a test of where market support is situated heading into the three-week recess, with a three-centre offering of 32,397 bales. Macwool and Carmichael and Co catalogued 1669 bales offered on Tuesday.

YOUR WOOL IN SAFE HANDS



Ray White

RICHARDSON AND SINCLAIR

Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE.. 2310 head. Weaners to suit restockers, very few young steers to suit feeders. Prime grown steers and heifers well supplied, fair numbers of cows. Young trade cattle 15c cheaper, vealers and yearlings 482c to 544c/kg. Few feeder steers firm, heifers 10c to 20c/kg cheaper. Feeder steers 522c to 618c, heifers 486c to 558c/kg. Top young cattle to restockers dearer though overall young cattle were 30c/kg cheaper. Young steers to restockers 695c, ave 600c, heifers to 705c/kg. Grown steers and heifers up to 12c dearer, steers 428c to 492c/kg, heifers 450c to 484c/kg. Cows 4c to 9c dearer, 2 and 3 scores to processors 355c to 408c, heavy cows 395c to 435c, ave 421c/kg. Cows to restockers 344c to 410c/kg. Heavy bulls to 438c/kg.

DUBBO SHEEP.. 14,160 lambs. Good runs of well finished heavies, fair numbers of trade. Merino lambs well supplied as were exotics. Trade lambs \$10 to \$15 cheaper, 20kg to 24kg \$220 to \$296, ave 1140c to 1200c/kg cwt. A single pen of heavy trade new season \$313. Heavy lambs \$22 cheaper, 24kg to 30kg \$290 to \$330, ave 1080c/kg cwt. Over 30kg \$326 to \$365. Heavy new season \$320. Trade Merino lambs \$12 cheaper, \$210 to \$285. Heavy Merino firm to \$316. Lambs to restockers close to firm, crossbreds and exotics \$112 to \$258, feeder lambs firm to \$300. Hoggets to \$296.

MUTTON.. 4400 head mostly good quality, most grades \$10 dearer. Merino ewes \$180 to \$338, crossbred ewes \$236 to \$330. Merino wethers \$220 to \$325, light Merino wethers to fatteners \$166 to \$182. Most mutton 900c to 980c/kg cwt.

WOOL.. Only Eastern seaboard in action with just over 21,000 bales offered. Headline market indicators closed slightly cheaper, but individual micron indicator categories once again produced mixed results, ranging from plus 24cents for the 18-micron indicator to minus 36cents for Merino Cardings. Northern region was largely a positive start on Tuesday with buyers targeting the higher strength, lower vegetable matter types, pushing the indicator 3cents higher by the end of the day. Wednesday’s results reversed some of the gains with the Merino carding indicator and to a lesser extent crossbreds dragging the indicator down 9 cents. 19,415 bales sold nationally with a passed-in rate of 8.5%. We are three weeks into the new selling season, and it has been a very calm start with just 8cents separating the closing weekly levels of the EMI. More importantly it has been an extremely positive start to 2026/27 with the first three sales returning prices on average 57% better than last season. 70% better than 2024/25 and 62% better than 2023/24. Next week is the final sale before the annual three-week recess. With the Western region back in action the national offering rises to an expected 32,397 bales.

Around the tracks with Col Hodges

Racing at Carinda

BRONCO LUNN has owned abundant winners but few if any could match the moment on Saturday when he proudly held the gold trophy after winning for the first time, his hometown Carinda Cup.

Raced in partnership with good friend and prominent owner James Carolan from Dubbo, Edge Of Reward was heavily supported in the betting ring with a big punter collecting numerous bets of \$3000 to \$1000 and \$2700 to \$1000, however The Great Armada started the \$2 favourite for the feature race.

Sponsored by the Carinda Hotel, venue of the 1983 “Let’s Dance” video clip of famous English singer David Bowie performing at the village pub in the outback, the 2026 Carinda Cup was watched by a crowd of over 700.

Now trained at Dubbo by Connie Greig, Edge Of Reward was aggressively ridden by Jake Pracey-Holmes to assume the frontrunners role.

Under siege at the top of the straight by several rivals, Edge Of Reward (\$3 to \$2.50) under strong riding by Pracey-Holmes fought on to win by almost a length from The Great Armada (Hollie Hull, \$2 fav) while the 11-year-old rank outsider Ocean Hero (Dylan Stanley, \$25) ran a great race for third for trainer Todd Smith after looking a winning chance in the straight.

Reared at Carinda, Dubbo trainer Dar Lunn, a brother of Bronco Lunn, was back home for the day to win the 1400m Lend Me 100 Syndicate Maiden Plate with Windsor Road.

Owned by former Walgett based jockey Graham Bradley, Windsor Road (\$2.80) well ridden in the lead by Jess Del Frari defeated the Garry Lunn trained Chrislyn (Dylan Stanley, \$1.50 fav) and Lotina (Leanne Boyd, \$6).

Jess Del Frari who rode over 50 winners before taking a lengthy break from riding, recently became apprenticed to Forbes trainer Melissa Harrison and Windsor Road was her first winner for over two years.

Carrying the colours of the late, great trainer John Lundholm from Coonamble, Notabadchassis trained at Dubbo by John’s grandson Clint Lundholm, won the 1100m OMG Shearing Benchmark 45 Handicap.

Riding in great form, the Lundholm stable apprentice Zoe Hunt led throughout on Notabadchassis (\$5.50) to account for Outback Cod (Dylan Stanley, \$10) and Johnny Boz (Gabrielle Johnston, \$4.60).

Clint Lundholm with the Carinda win by Notabadchassis, completed a good week, having won the last race at Cowra with Moonzone (Kody Nestor) and two days later, the last at Dubbo with Moonzone (Zoe Hunt).

Phillip and Sandra Gray, the owners from Coonamble of Notabadchassis, had several good horses trained by John Lundholm including What A Life, winner of five country area Cups, including the Warren Cup, Narromine Cup and Coonabarabran Cup.

Second leg of double for Zoe Hunt was the Brett Thompson trained Abated Breath (\$2 fav) which was backing up from a last start win at Coonabarabran TAB meeting and after setting the pace won the 1400m Dubbo City Toyota & Gilgandra Toyota Class 1 Handicap by a length from Broadcast Boogie (Jake Pracey-Holmes, \$2.50) and I’m Kenough (Hollie Hull, \$7).

Big punters who backed the Connie Greig trained Culgoa Kate(Jake Pracey-Holmes) from \$1.70 to \$1.22 for the 1000m McNamara Earth Moving Maiden Handicap did not have an easy watch, however the favourite owned by the Knight and Holland families from Bourke found enough after leading to stave off by a long neck Aphelion (Dylan Stanley, \$6.50) and Inquisitrix (Jess Del Frari, \$6).

After several big payouts during the day, the bookies recouped some of their cash in the last when Bold Tyrant trained at Narromine by Michael Plummer, won the 1700m Coonamble Ag Spray Benchmark 50 Handicap.

Worked through the field by Ken Dunbar, Bold Tyrant (\$9) overhauled the leaders in the straight and won by over four lengths from last start 2200m Dubbo TAB winner Godwits, Georgina McDonnell, (2.60 fav) which came from well back while Allande (Hollie Hull, \$13) battled on for third.

Coonabarabran (TAB) and Trangie Picnics race on Saturday, Bathurst (TAB) on Tuesday, July 28.



Wellingtons ‘Stray Notes’ choir performing at 2026 Wellington Eisteddfod

WELLINGTON’S own ‘Stray Notes’ choir has been busy rehearsing for the upcoming Wellington Eisteddfod. ‘Stray Notes’ has been attending the local Eisteddfod for many years and it is one of the highlights on their annual calendar. The choir would like to invite the Wellington community

to attend and support them and this wonderful community event. They will perform at the Wellington Civic Centre at 5.30pm on Wednesday, July 29 with five songs in the Open Choir Section including the full SATB choir (soprano, alto, tenor, bass) as well as several songs by the Stray Notes Ladies choir. The sections are Open Choir Group, Sacred

Song and pen/Popular/Barbershop chorus. “Stray Notes” is led by Choir Director/Conductor: Lindy Blakemore and Choral Accompanist Dionne Mitchell. The choir will be gathering afterwards with family and friends at Black Cats Cocktails for some celebratory drinks and refreshments - all welcome.

2026 Wellington Eisteddfod Program

Tuesday 28 and Wednesday 29 July, 2026. - Music Program

Tuesday, 28 July, 2026 Morning Commences at 10:00 AM
M095 Special Needs Choir SCHOOL CHOIR GROUP Any Age
May sing one or two songs
1 Yawarra Community School
2 Wellington Public School Support Group
3 Wellington Public School
M0XX Pre-school/Daycare PERCUSSION BANDS GROUP
May use body percussion and competitors can enter multiple times.
1 Family Daycare
2 Wellington Public Preschool
M065 Infants (Kindergarten - 2) PERCUSSION BANDS GROUP Junior
May use body percussion and competitors can enter multiple times.
M096 Kindergarten, Years 1 and 2 SCHOOL CHOIR GROUP Junior
Two Contrasting Songs of Choice
1 Wellington Public School - Stage
M097 Primary SCHOOL CHOIR - years 3 and 4 SCHOOL CHOIR GROUP Junior
Two Contrasting Songs of Choice
1 Wellington Public School Stage 2
M066 Primary (Years 3 - 6) PERCUSSION BANDS GROUP Junior
May use body percussion and competitors can enter multiple times.
1 Parkes Public School
M098 Primary SCHOOL CHOIR - years 5 and 6 SCHOOL CHOIR GROUP Junior
Two Contrasting Songs of Choice
1 Wellington Public School - Stage 3
2 Gulgong Public School
M101 School Singing Choir SCHOOL CHOIR GROUP Any Age
Two Contrasting Songs of Choice
1 Saint John’s Primary, Dubbo
M100 Secondary School Choir SCHOOL CHOIR GROUP Intermediate/Senior
Two Contrasting Songs of Choice
1 St Mary’s Catholic School Yr 7 & Yr 8

Tuesday, 28 July, 2026 Afternoon Commences at 1:30 PM
M025 10 years and Under STRING SOLO Junior
Violin, Viola, Cello, Double Bass
1 Ella Holland
M026 12 years and Under STRING SOLO Junior
Violin, Viola, Cello, Double Bass

1 Erin Pearson
M029 Preliminary & 1st Grade GRADED STRING SOLO Any Age
Violin, Viola, Cello, Double Bass
1 Ella Holland
2 Erin Pearson
M034 Open STRING DUO/TRIO Any Age
Accompaniment Optional
1 Ella Holland & Jessica Holland
2 Alison Williams & Jessica Holland
M045 15 years and Under WOODWIND SOLO Intermediate/Senior
Piccolo, Flute, Oboe, Clarinet, Saxophone, Bassoon, Recorder
1 Julia Nicholson
2 Ariana Johnston
3 Annabel Roberts
4 Lilly Roberts
M049 5th, 6th, 7th and 8th Grades GRADED WOODWIND SOLO Any Age
Piccolo, Flute, Oboe, Clarinet, Saxophone, Bassoon, Recorder
1 Julia Nicholson
M044 12 years and Under WOODWIND SOLO Junior
Piccolo, Flute, Oboe, Clarinet, Saxophone, Bassoon, Recorder
1 Caylee Johnston
M059 Preliminary 1st & 2nd Grade GRADED BRASS SOLO Any Age
Cornet, Trumpet, French Horn, Tenor Horn, Trombone, Baritone, Euphonium, Tuba
1 Alexie Muller
M056 12 years and Under BRASS INSTRUMENTAL SOLO Junior
Cornet, Trumpet, French Horn, Tenor Horn, Trombone, Baritone, Euphonium, Tuba
1 Charlee Clavell
2 Zoe Rich

Wednesday, 29 July, 2026 Morning Commences at 9:00 AM
M001 Beginners -10 years and Under PIANO - BEGINNERS SOLO Junior
Lessons for 18 months or less
1 Sophie Finn
2 Eva Spradbrow
3 Camilla Holland
M002 8 Years & Under PIANO SOLO Junior
1 Camilla Holland
2 Skylar James

...Continued on Page 16.

2026 Wellington Eisteddfod

Program - continued

Tuesday 28 and Wednesday 29 July, 2026. - Music Program

M003 9 years & under PIANO SOLO Junior
1 Bella Hartsuyker
2 Elsie Gain
3 Summer Whillock
4 Annabel Holland M004 10 years & Under PIANO SOLO Junior
1 Sophie Finn
M005 11 years and Under PIANO SOLO Junior
1 George Denovan
2 Polly Whillock
3 Brodie Frogley
4 Cameron Lewis
5 Genevieve Power
6 Sylvie Laurie
M006 12 years & Under PIANO SOLO Junior
2 Izabel Denison
M010 Preliminary GRADED PIANO SOLO Any Age
1 Elsie Gain
M011 1st Grade GRADED PIANO SOLO Any Age
1 Bella Hartsuyker
2 Sylvie Laurie
3 Brodie Frogley
M012 2nd Grade GRADED PIANO SOLO Any Age
1 George Denovan
2 Polly Whillock
M013 3rd & 4th Grades GRADED PIANO SOLO Any Age
1 Izabel Denison
2 Cameron Lewis
M015 7th & 8th Grades GRADED PIANO SOLO Any Age
1 Paul Isaac Karas
M016 12 years and Under PIANO DUET Junior
1 Izabel Denison & Skylar James
M018 10 years and Under MODERN PIANO SOLO Junior
Popular, Blues, Boogie, Jazz, Rock etc
1 Bella Hartsuyker
2 Elsie Gain
3 Summer Whillock
4 Eva Spradbrow
5 Annabel Holland
M019 11 and 12 years only MODERN PIANO SOLO Junior
Popular, Blues, Boogie, Jazz, Rock etc
1 Paul Isaac Karas
2 George Denovan
3 Polly Whillock
4 Sylvie Laurie
5 Izabel Denison
6 Brodie Frogley
7 Cameron Lewis
8 Genevieve Power
M022 12 years & Under BAROQUE PIANO SOLO Junior
Music from the c.1600 to c. 1750
1 Brodie Frogley
2 Cameron Lewis

Wednesday, 29 July, 2026 Afternoon Commences at 1:30 PM
M079 6 years and Under Nursery Rhyme in Costume VOCAL SOLO Junior

Microphone
1 Maisie Whillock
M090 12 years and Under VOCAL - BEGINNERS SOLO Junior
Lessons for 18 months or less + Microphone Optional
1 Summer Whillock
2 Rupert Comiskey
M092 12 years and Under VOCAL DUO/TRIO Junior
Microphone Optional
1 Greta Comiskey & Summer Whillock
M081 13 to 16 years VOCAL SOLO Intermediate/Senior
Microphone Optional
1 Scarlett Fox
2 Amelia Williams
3 Madeline Flannery
M082 13 to 16 years VOCAL - POPULAR, ROCK, BLUES OR JAZZ SOLO
Intermediate/Senior
Microphone Optional
1 Scarlett Fox
2 Madeline Flannery
M083 13 to 16 years VOCAL - MUSICAL THEATRE OR OPERETTA SOLO
Intermediate/Senior
Costume + Microphone Optional
1 Scarlett Fox
2 Madeline Flannery
M084 Open VOCAL - MUSICAL THEATRE OR OPERETTA SOLO Any Age
Costume + Microphone Optional
1 Scarlett Fox
2 Penny Flannery
M085 Open VOCAL - POPULAR, ROCK, BLUES OR JAZZ SOLO Any Age
excluding Musical Theatre + Microphone Optional
1 Scarlett Fox
M087 Open VOCAL - ART SONG SOLO Any Age
Art Song
1 Scarlett Fox
2 Penny Flannery
M088 Open VOCAL - SACRED SONG OR ARIA SOLO Any Age
Sacred or Aria
1 Penny Flannery
M089 Adult VOCAL - ANY GENRE SOLO Any Age
Microphone Optional
1 Penny Flannery
M091 Open VOCAL - BEGINNERS SOLO Any Age
Lessons for 18 months or less + Microphone Optional
1 Amelia Williams
M102 Open Choir Group OPEN CHOIR GROUP Any Age
Two songs of choice - any arrangement
1 Stray Notes SATB Choir
2 Stray Notes Ladies Choir
M104 Open - Sacred Song OPEN CHOIR GROUP Any Age
Two songs of choice - any arrangement
1 Stray Notes SATB Choir
2 Stray Notes Ladies Choir
M105 Open -Popular; Show/Barbershop Chorus OPEN CHOIR GROUP Any Age
Costume and Choreography Optional
1 Stray Notes SATB Choir

The Eisteddfod Music adjudicator, Anne Stevens, joins us from her home town of Orange. Anne has studied both piano and flute and is a chamber musician, playing with Viola.

She has been a tireless and energetic advocate of chamber music and instrumental performance and played an enormous role in the development of music in the Central Western Region of NSW. The Wellington Eisteddfod Committee looks forward to welcoming Anne to Wellington next week.

Check out our website

Scanthe QR code on your phone or device



Throwback Thursday

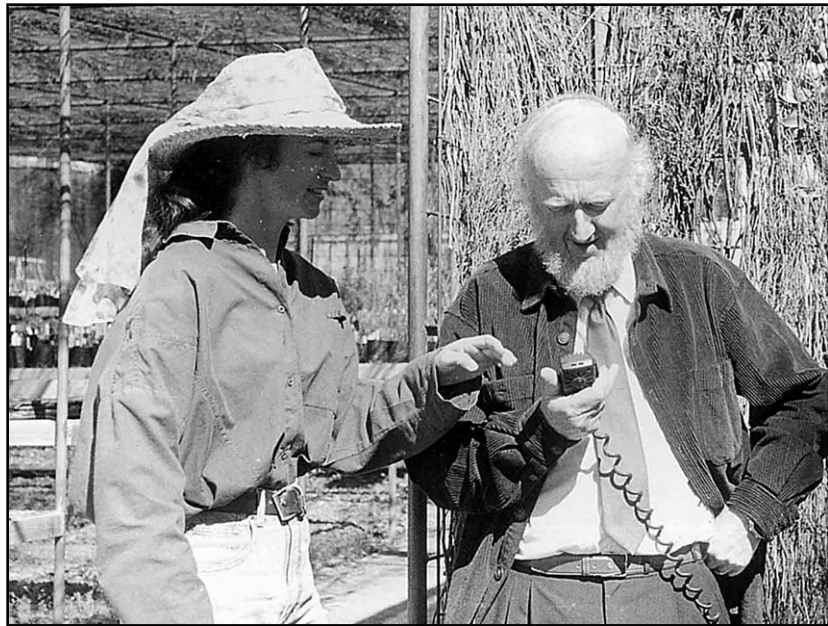
Looking back at some photos of locals as they were several decades ago - provided by readers who want to preserve Wellington history.



Who could ever forget the late Jim Harris. He was certainly one of Wellington's greatest characters. He is pictured eating the first hamburger made at the official opening of McDonalds in the late 1990s. He always had a word on anything and said he was one who saw the "Wellington Yowie" when driving home from an afternoon and evening in town, but never saw it on the way into town. There are hundreds of yarns people who knew would remember.



Wellington Race Club personalities, Colleen Dwyer, Norm McCure and Karen McCarroll.



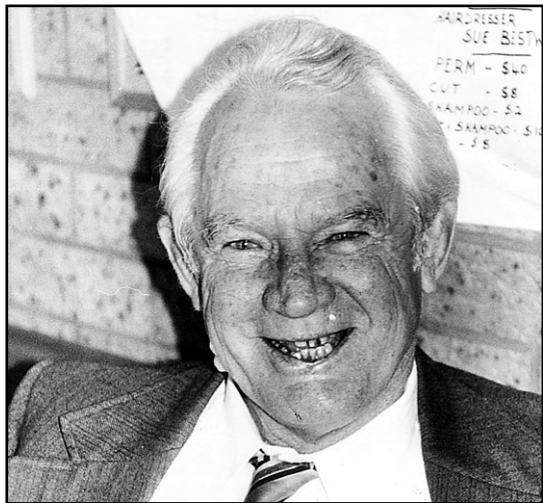
Netta Holmes with Professor David Yoldney at the Burrendong Arboretum.



Wellington's own formidable Duke and Dutchess (David Thompson and Peter Burke) popped up at many of Wellington's events, mostly uninvited. So they gate-crashed, just like they did at the 1992 official opening of the new Macquarie Bridge (pictured here walking across heading the cavalcade of vehicles and people after being forbidden to participate in the official opening by then RTA powers that be. When the Army Pontoon bridge was ready for opening some months after the old Macquarie bridge collapse, the Duke and Dutchess were invited to do the official honours, however, they were "De Grooted" by Mr Wellington Boot (Mike Hayes) who cut the ribbon before they could. There were six bridges across the Macquarie River between the old and new bridges: pontoon, Bailey, railway bridge (used on two different occasions) and the Duke of Wellington low-level bridge (which was actually opened in the Civic Centre by the real Duke and his Duchess as the Macquarie River was in flood at the time with no safe access to the bridge.



Salvation Army members at the front of the Lee Street Citadel.



Wellington's barber extraordinaire, the late Leo Duff was another of this town's greatest characters. Volumes could be written about Leo.



Judith Scott and Chris Lago at Community Health Centre.





St Mary's Catholic School

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Ph: (02) 68451822
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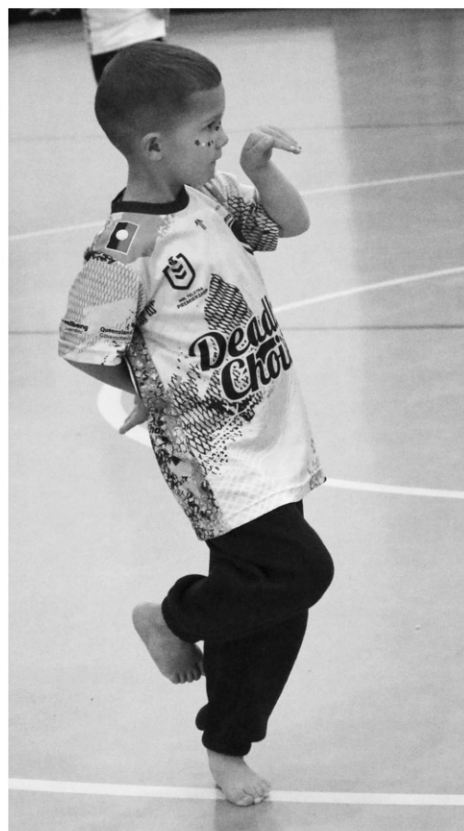


St Mary's Celebrates NAIDOC and 50 Years of Deadly

On the last day of Term 2, St Mary's students and staff celebrated NAIDOC Day with a range of activities recognising Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander cultures and traditions.

The day began with a powerful and grounding Welcome to Country and Smoking Ceremony before students worked in their Kinship groups to rotate through a variety of hands-on learning experiences, including Dinawan's Connection Dance Workshop, STEM projects, beading and weaving, johnny cake and bush tucker activities, and TIG (Traditional Indigenous Games). A delicious curry lunch, prepared by Mrs Sears, Ms Hodges and student helpers, was enjoyed by all.

St Mary's extends its sincere thanks to Mrs Sears, Ms Hodges, the visiting presenters, dedicated staff and St Mary's students for bringing such energy to the day. It truly was a celebration of "50 Years of Deadly."



Golfing News

James McGrath wins Diggers golf

DIGGERS GOLF last week was a Stroke event won by James McGrath who showed all, a clean pair of heels to finish the day with a 64nett.

Runner-up was Jan Payne who played well to finish with a 70nett, she also claimed the Putting prize with 29putts.

Nearest the Pin on 8th Archie McMaster and Warren Hurst; 16th Wayne Lang and Peter Neuenhaus.

If playing your Round 2 matches of the Lion of Waterloo Trophy you need to tee off the Blue tees, otherwise your match will be declared null and void.

Ladies are to play Round 2 of their Pennants, best of luck.

Last Saturday's Individual Stableford was played in three grades.

A grade winner was John Donnelly who put together a good score of 32pts, while Tim Parker was runner-up on 35pts.

Early riser Gary McCarroll, with 38pts, won B grade just ahead of Damien Clarke with 37pts.

C grade winner, also an early starter, was Ryan McCracken with 37pts with Peter Neuenhaus the runner-up on 36pts.

Prize winners were Steven McCarroll 35pts; George Keatinge, David Naveau 34pts; Matt Ringland, Mitchell Cusack, Paul Hannelly, Phil Barrett 32pts.

NTP on 3rd Mitchell Cusack, 8th Lewis Stanley, 14th Ollie Keatinge, 16th Tim Parker.

NTP in two shots on the first hole went to Mitchell

Cusack.

Longest drives on the 10th Tim Parker in A grade and in B grade on the 12th hole, Brad Conn.

The Brent Eather Encouragement award went to Liam Conn who started all smiles, by the time he finished there wasn't a smile to be seen, final score 17pts.

Wednesday's Individual Stableford winner with an absolutely astonishing round was Densie Haesler finishing with 40pts.

Runner-up was Jan Payne with 34pts on a countback. Prize winner was Wendy Slack-Smith 34pts. NTPs, Marie Cornish, Pauline Potts.

Peter Holden found some form to win Thursday's Individual Stableford. He tallied 37pts while runner-up on 35 was Daniel McCullum. Prize winner was James Armstrong 33pts.

Round 2 of the Lion of Waterloo Trophy to be played by August 8.

Golf Club Advisory Committee is clamping down on slow play and those golfers not repairing their divots or pitch marks, and destroying the tee markers. Please stop as it's becoming very expensive to keep on buying them.

This Saturday's event is Round 2 of the Joe Ryans Mowing Winter Cup, Red Tee's to be used.

19th Hole



Mitchell Cusack snuck in a two-shot win on the first hole then nearest the pin on the third last Saturday.

CASH FEVER

\$3,700

If NOT won \$3,800

Sunday Night



LIVE MUSIC

FRIDAY 8TH AUGUST
FROM 7:30PM

#



TRACIE, MICK AND DEB



Gamble Help is close at hand Gambleaware.nsw.gov.au | 1800 858858 | gambleaware.nsw.gov.au

ARTHUR STREET, WELLINGTON | INFORMATION FOR MEMBERS AND THEIR GUEST

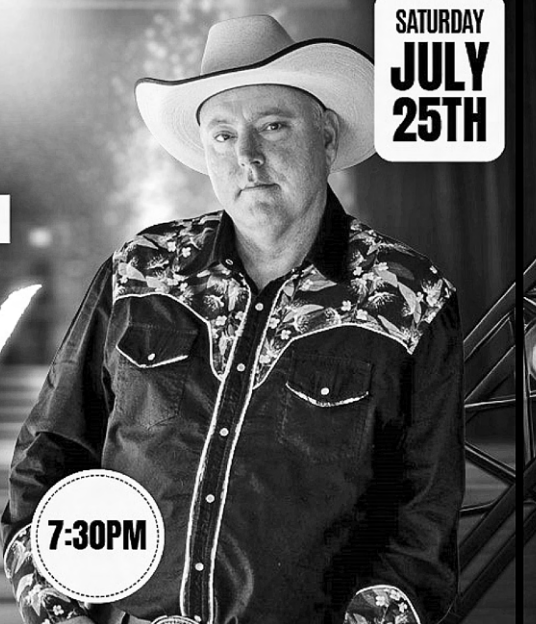




LIVE COUNTRY MUSIC

JUSTIN Landers

7:30PM



SATURDAY JULY 25TH

MEMBERS BADGE DRAW

\$3,200

If NOT won \$3,300

Friday Night

20 THURSDAY, JULY 23, 2026, WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER